

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 3

♥ 10 5 4

♦ K J 10

♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7

♥ A Q 9 8 6 2

♦ Q 7

♣ 7 5 2



♠ 6 5 4 2

♥ J

♦ 9 8 4 3

♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J

♥ K 7 3

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ 8 6 4

West

1NT

All Pass

4♥ by North
rectified.

North

2♥

East

Pass

South

4♥

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣J. West wins
♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

West takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9
winners.

West opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and East
has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and
♦K are with West and you will have to put the
squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with
the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already

You plan to squeeze West by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a
Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps
with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to West.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. West is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

[showcards N:SA,SK,SJ,D6 E:SQ,ST,S9,DK S:S8,S7,H6,DQ W:S6,S5,D9,D8]

West is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

West can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card
MUST be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one
♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not West.

If you discard the ♦6 West will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, West will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for
his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ K Q 10 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ -

♠ Q 7

♥ A 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ A J 9 7 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6 ♣
All Pass			

6 ♣ by South

Unblocking the ♠ A to create a Threat out of your ♠ Q is the Vienna Coup.

As you see, East was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣ 7 and discard dummy's ♠ 2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠ K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠ Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6 ♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥ K.

South is to play 6 ♣. West leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠ K and that a squeeze will be possible.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you should rectify the count, so you win the first trick, pull trumps in two rounds, then give up a ♥ trick.

West takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦ 9 which you win with your ♦ Q.

You now make the key play of taking dummy's ♠ A before running three rounds of ♣ s.

[showcards N:S2,DA,DK,D8 E:SK,DJ,DT,D7 S:SQ,D5,D4,C7 W:SJ,ST,HQ,D2]